A SMALL-PARTY PRINTABLE

Six-Week Countdown

A small gathering doesn't need a big machine to organize it — just a gentle pace. This sheet walks you from six weeks out to the day of, one easy focus per week, so the work happens in small forgettable pieces instead of one frantic afternoon.

How to use it

1. Write your party date at the top of page 2, then mark which week you're already in. Mid-countdown is a perfectly good place to start.
2. Each week, read its one big job and do that job first. The smaller chores can scatter through the days where they fit.
3. Tick the box only when the big job is handled. Half-done counts as “in motion” — momentum is allowed on this sheet.
4. Printed this late in the game? Skip to the week you're actually in. A shorter countdown still counts; it just moves faster.
5. Keep page 2 on the fridge and fill page 3 as you go — write freely, scratch through anything that stops mattering.

What's inside

- **Page 2** — the countdown at a glance: one focus and one big job per week.
- **Page 3** — week-by-week details with room to write each week's real to-dos.

> **A kind note:** the parties people remember are mostly made of one thing — that you had them at all. The centerpieces will not be remembered. You will be.

Print at 100% (“Actual size”), US Letter, portrait. Prints nicely in black & white. Personal use: print as many copies as you like.

Six-Week Countdown

My party: _____ Today I'm starting at week: _____

Week	Focus	The one big job	Done
Week 6	Dream it	*Set the date, pick the one-word vibe — write yours over the hint*	☐
Week 5	Guests	*Guest list finished, invites out (a text counts)*	☐
Week 4	Food	*Menu settled, potluck sign-ups going around*	☐
Week 3	Supplies	*Store run for cups & napkins, prep anything that freezes*	☐
Week 2	Tidy	*One helping room clean enough, borrow what you need*	☐
Week 1	Almost	*Cook ahead, check in with maybes, buy the perishables*	☐
Day of	Welcome	*Tidy the entryway, feed yourself, open the door*	☐

How “done” works: done means the big job is handled — not perfect, not finished early, just handled. The rest of the week breathes.

Week by Week, Gently

Little jobs under each big job — cross out whatever doesn't fit your party.

Week & focus	This week's happenings	Done
6 · Dream it	*A date that doesn't collide · a one-word vibe · a rough headcount that feels cozy, not cramped*	☐
5 · Guests	*Invites out, any way · start the guest tracker · a maybe is still an RSVP in progress*	☐
4 · Food	*Draft menu · open the potluck sign-up card · borrow or book anything big*	☐
3 · Supplies	*Cups, napkins, candles shop run · prep what freezes · chase loose ends*	☐
2 · Tidy	*One helping room at a time · plan where people sit & stand · borrow chairs if you're short*	☐
1 · Almost	*Cook ahead what you can · a kind nudge to the maybes · perishables in the cart*	☐
Day of	*Entryway only, not the whole house · something real to eat for you · door opens on time*	☐

Behind schedule? The whole party can be carried by Week 1 and the day of: food, an entryway, an open door. Everything earlier is garnish.